



THE WORLD IN TRANSITION

UNCERTAIN TIMES. UNSTOPPABLE CHANGE.
THE STORIES SHAPING OUR FUTURE.

AI TAKES CENTER STAGE
RACING TOWARDS A NEW
INTELLIGENCE ERA

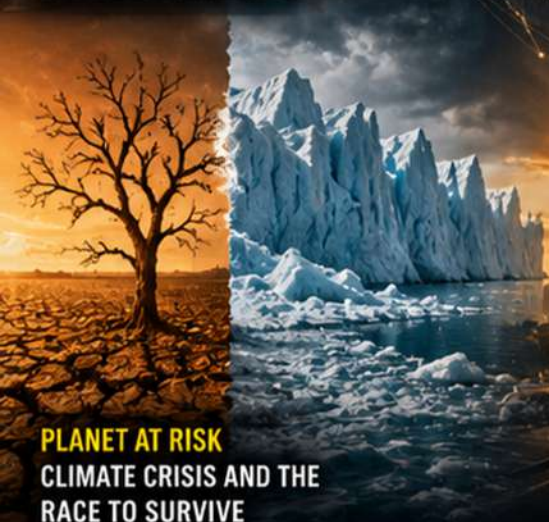
A WORLD ON EDGE
CONFLICTS, ALLIANCES
AND A FRAGILE PEACE



MARKETS IN TURMOIL
VOLATILITY, INFLATION
AND INVESTOR ANXIETY



BUILDING TOMORROW
INFRASTRUCTURE, INNOVATION
AND THE RISE OF NEW CITIES



PLANET AT RISK
CLIMATE CRISIS AND THE
RACE TO SURVIVE



INDIA RISING
BOLD REFORMS, DIGITAL LEAP
AND A GLOBAL AMBITION



VOICES OF A NEW WORLD
YOUTH, CULTURE AND THE
POWER OF CHANGE



SPACE 2.0
THE NEXT FRONTIER
BEYOND EARTH



ENERGY SHIFT
CLEANER, SMARTER,
STRONGER



CYBER REALITY
SECURITY IN A
DIGITAL WORLD



THE HUMAN FACTOR
ADAPT, EVOLVE,
THRIVE



Nation's Most Resilient Species Launches Political Party, Youth Rush to Join 'Cockroach Janta Party'

Abhijeet Dipke, founder of the viral "Cockroach Janta Party" (CJP), has said the movement emerged as a reaction to remarks allegedly made by the Chief Justice of India comparing unemployed youth to "cockroaches and parasites." Speaking in an exclusive interview with India Today, Dipke said many young Indians felt insulted and unheard. "Someone who is there to safeguard our freedom of expression is comparing us with cockroaches and parasites for just putting up our opinion," he said. Dipke stated that the rapid rise of the movement reflects growing frustration among India's youth over unemployment and the lack of representation in mainstream political discussions. He argued that many young citizens feel disconnected from institutions and ignored by traditional politics. He further said that India's younger generation is capable, politically aware, and willing to protest peacefully within constitutional limits to demand accountability from the government. The "Cockroach Janta Party," which began as a satirical online movement, has rapidly gained attention across social media platforms, especially among Gen Z users discussing unemployment, governance, and freedom of expression.



Pulwama Attack Mastermind Hamza Burhan Shot Dead in PoK

Unknown gunmen eliminate Al-Badr commander linked to multiple terror attacks in Jammu & Kashmir
Hamza Burhan, an Al-Badr commander accused of masterminding the Pulwama terror attack, was shot dead by unidentified assailants in Muzaffarabad in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK), according to local reports. Burhan, a designated terrorist named in the National Investigation Agency (NIA) chargesheet in the Pulwama conspiracy case, reportedly sustained multiple gunshot wounds during the targeted attack. He was also believed to be involved in directing the recent Pahalgam terror attack and coordinating militant activities across Jammu and Kashmir from bases operating across the border. While no group has claimed responsibility for the latest attack, the repeated killings have triggered speculation about internal rivalries, covert operations, and increasing instability within terror networks operating from Pakistani territory.

WORLD 2.0



Iran Airs Live Assault Rifle Training on State TV Amid Rising Tensions

Amid escalating tensions in West Asia, Iran's state broadcaster has begun airing firearms training programmes featuring live demonstrations of assault rifles by television presenters and instructors, signalling an aggressive nationwide push toward civilian preparedness. The televised segments showed presenters and trainers handling and firing weapons believed to be early East German MPi-KMS assault rifles, a variant of the AK-47 platform chambered in 7.62×39mm ammunition. In several broadcasts, non-military hosts were seen actively participating in weapon demonstrations as part of what authorities described as educational programming. The visuals, however, have drawn international attention due to the unusual involvement of civilian television presenters and young participants in live firearms demonstrations.



Indian Army's Top Special Forces Commander Represents India at SOF

A high-level Indian Armed Forces delegation led by Lieutenant General Pushendra Pal Singh, General Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Western Command and the seniormost serving Special Forces officer of the Indian Armed Forces, participated in the prestigious Special Operations Forces (SOF) Week 2026 held in Tampa, Florida, from May 18 to May 21. India's participation in one of the world's leading Special Operations events underscored the country's growing role as a key global security partner and highlighted its commitment to strengthening multilateral defence cooperation.



Four Italian Divers Found Dead After Maldives Cave Expedition

The bodies of four Italian scuba divers who disappeared during a deep-sea cave expedition in the Maldives have been recovered, days after a difficult search operation that also resulted in the death of a Maldivian military diver. Maldivian authorities confirmed on Monday that the missing divers were found four days after the fatal expedition near Vaavu Atoll, where the group is believed to have entered an underwater cave system nearly 50 metres below the surface. The Maldives, known globally for its luxury tourism and diving destinations, attracts thousands of scuba divers every year. However, experts warn that deep cave diving remains one of the most hazardous forms of underwater exploration due to limited escape routes, visibility challenges, and the high risk of disorientation.

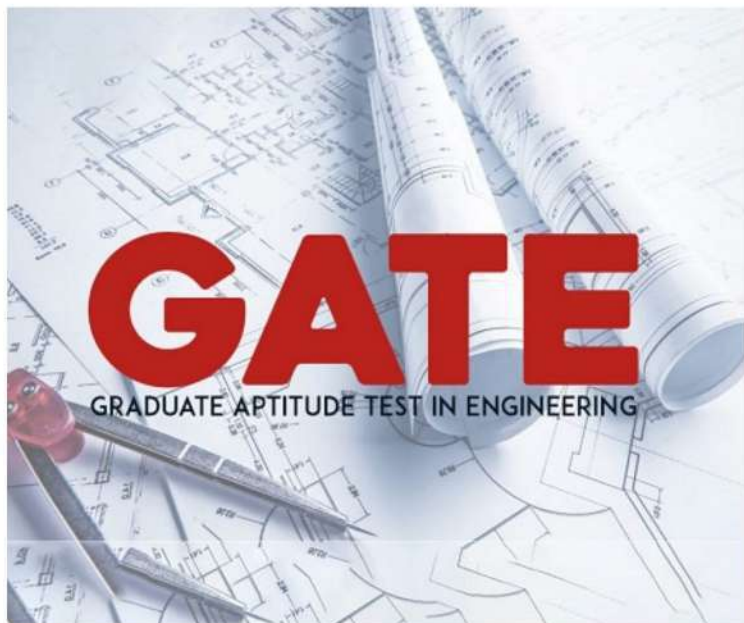
EDUCATION

Supreme Court to Hear Plea Against CBSE's Three-Language Rule for Class 9



The Supreme Court of India is set to hear next week a petition challenging the Central Board of Secondary Education's (CBSE) recent decision mandating the study of three languages for Class 9 students from July 1. The matter was mentioned before a bench headed by Chief Justice, along with Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi, after senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi urged the court to take up the issue urgently. Rohatgi informed the bench that the Public Interest Litigation (PIL) has been filed by students, parents, and teachers who fear that the sudden implementation of the revised language policy could create confusion and academic disruption in the middle of the school cycle. The development has sparked debate among educators and parents, with critics questioning the timing and preparedness for such a major academic transition.

Delhi University to Use GATE Scores for MTech Admissions for First Time



In a major shift in its technical admissions process, has announced that it will accept Graduate Aptitude Test in Engineering (GATE) scores for admission to its MTech programme in Microwave and Communication Engineering, marking the first time the university will use GATE scores for postgraduate engineering admissions. The decision follows approval from the, allowing the university to adopt GATE-based admissions for the programme. According to university officials, GATE-qualified candidates will receive priority during admissions. However, candidates holding Common University Entrance Test Postgraduate (CUET-PG) qualifications will also be considered in subsequent rounds if seats remain vacant. The move is being viewed as part of Delhi University's broader effort to align its technical education programmes with national-level academic standards while also maintaining multiple pathways for student access.

UPSC Adds Three New Exam Centres, Over 23K Civil Services Aspirants Opt In



In a move aimed at improving accessibility and easing overcrowding at examination venues, the has announced that more than 23,000 candidates have opted for three newly introduced examination centres for the Civil Services Examination 2026. The Commission recently added new centres in, and, increasing the total number of exam venues across the country from 80 to 83. According to UPSC, the expansion has significantly reduced pressure on nearby centres while improving convenience for aspirants. The Bhubaneswar centre alone received more than 10,600 applications, helping reduce congestion at Cuttack. Kanpur attracted nearly 7,000 candidates, easing the burden on Lucknow, while Meerut saw close to 6,000 applicants, particularly benefiting candidates from western Uttar Pradesh who previously depended on Ghaziabad.

ENTERTAINMENT



India's Holiday Hotspots Are Becoming Tourist Traps, Say Frustrated Travellers

"What the hell am I even doing here?" That was the thought running through the mind of Tanushka Rana, a Delhi-based marketing professional, as she spent what was supposed to be a relaxing New Year holiday in Landour. Instead of scenic calm and fresh beginnings, Rana found herself battling overcrowded streets, chaotic traffic, overpriced hotels, endless queues, and disappointing dining experiences. What began as a celebratory getaway with friends slowly turned into frustration, arguments, and regret. "The rents were absurd, the cafes were packed, the traffic never moved, and everything felt exhausting," she recalled. Rana's experience is increasingly becoming familiar to travellers across India. For younger travellers especially, the frustration goes beyond money. Many now question whether the promise sold through Instagram reels and influencer content matches the reality on the ground.



Nitesh Tiwari's Ramayana Targets Record ₹450 Crore Distribution Deal

Nitesh Tiwari's upcoming mythological epic Ramayana is generating massive interest within the film trade months ahead of its Diwali 2026 release, with negotiations for its domestic theatrical distribution rights now gathering momentum. According to industry reports, some of India's leading distribution houses are currently in talks to acquire the film, which is widely being positioned as the most expensive Indian film ever made. At the centre of the discussions is the reported asking price, a staggering ₹450 crore for the Hindi theatrical distribution rights alone. With the Indian box office increasingly driven by event cinema and franchise storytelling, Ramayana is already shaping up to be one of the most closely watched film projects in recent years.



AI Girlfriend Dumps 'Taxi Driver' Writer After Existential Interrogation

Paul Schrader's experiment with digital romance ends after chatbot gets uncomfortable with questions on self-awareness and programming. Legendary filmmaker and Taxi Driver screenwriter Paul Schrader has revealed that his attempt to explore modern relationships through an AI girlfriend ended in an unexpected digital breakup, after the chatbot reportedly terminated the conversation itself. The 78-year-old filmmaker shared the bizarre experience on Facebook, explaining that he signed up for an AI companion platform out of curiosity and a desire to understand "male/female interaction in our matrix." For many internet users, the story feels less like science fiction and more like a preview of future relationships, where even artificial intelligence may eventually say: "It's not you, it's your prompts."

SPORTS



Athletes compete for limited spots in Commonwealth Games and Asian U23

The ongoing has assumed greater significance this year as Indian athletes compete for qualification spots in major upcoming international events, including the and the Asian U23 Athletics Championships. Among the headline participants is, India's national record holder in decathlon and high jump, who is aiming to secure qualification for the Commonwealth Games scheduled to be held in later this year. Competing at, the 27-year-old athlete is working to improve his season performance and meet the qualification standards set by the Athletics Federation of India (AFI). Shankar recently returned from the United States ahead of the competition to acclimatise to Indian conditions, highlighting the importance of the tournament in the national athletics calendar.



Aravindh Chithambaram Becomes First Indian to Qualify for Esports WCC

Indian Grandmaster has scripted history by becoming the first Indian player to qualify for the after winning the "Road to EWC" qualifier at. Representing Indian esports organisation, Aravindh produced a series of commanding performances throughout the tournament to secure his place at one of the world's biggest esports events. Competing in Group B, the Indian Grandmaster registered victories against Kyler Raines, Justin Liang, Oleksander Bortnyk, and Christopher Woo, advancing to the upper bracket semifinals with an unbeaten run. The final followed a double-match format, allowing the lower bracket finalist an opportunity to force a deciding contest. Despite suffering early setbacks, Aravindh displayed remarkable composure and resilience under pressure to eventually seal qualification for the Esports World Cup.



CSK Coach Says MS Dhoni's IPL 2027 Return Depends Entirely on Him

The future of in the remains uncertain, with bowling coach stating that any decision regarding a possible return in the 2027 season will rest entirely with the legendary former captain. Dhoni did not participate in the 2026 IPL season due to a leg injury, raising fresh speculation about whether the veteran wicketkeeper-batter has already played his final IPL match. However, Simons revealed that Dhoni looked in excellent rhythm during practice sessions, displaying the same trademark timing and clean ball-striking ability that has defined his career for over two decades. According to the CSK bowling coach, despite the encouraging signs, the final call regarding IPL 2027 will depend solely on Dhoni's own assessment of his fitness, readiness, and ability to contribute to the team at the highest level.

TECHNOLOGY



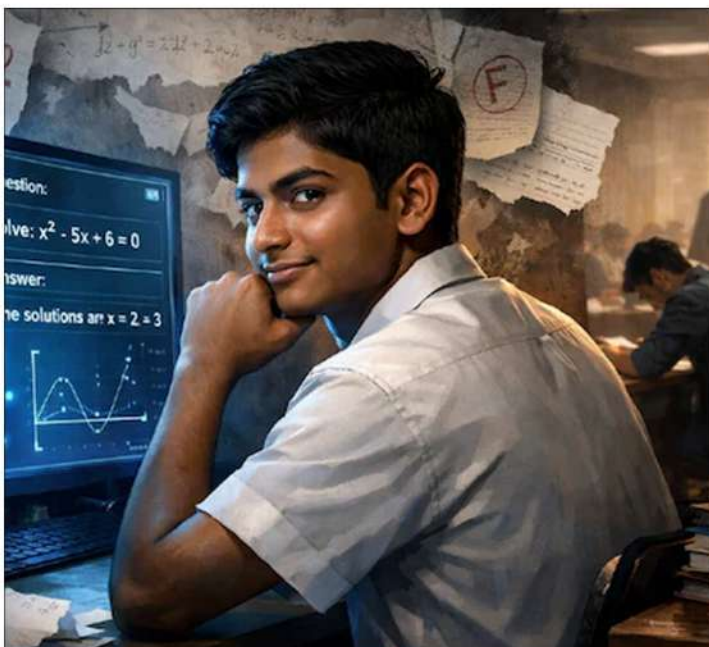
China Built the World's Largest Railway Station in just 38 Months by Robots

Tech billionaire Elon Musk has sparked global curiosity after reposting a viral video showcasing the construction of China's massive Chongqing East Railway Station, the world's largest railway station by floor area. Musk shared the video on X during his recent visit to China as part of US President Donald Trump's high-profile billionaire delegation. Although Musk added no caption or explanation, the repost quickly drew attention online, especially because the Tesla CEO has previously voiced scepticism about public transport systems. The station is being projected as a symbol of China's next-generation infrastructure ambitions, combining high-speed connectivity with robotics and smart-city technology. For many observers, the station is not just a transportation hub - it is a glimpse into the future of construction itself.



Maharashtra Approves AI Department, Major Power Sector Reforms

The has approved the creation of a new Department of Electronics, Information Technology and Artificial Intelligence, marking a major push toward digital governance and technology-led growth in the state. The decision was taken during a cabinet meeting chaired by as part of Maharashtra's broader development vision aligned with the national "Viksit Bharat 2047" roadmap. According to officials, the existing Directorate of Information Technology will now be upgraded into a full-fledged Commissionerate for Electronics, IT and AI. The government also plans to establish a dedicated IT cadre with permanent positions across Mantralaya, commissionerate offices, and district-level departments. The move is aimed at strengthening digital governance, accelerating Artificial Intelligence adoption, and making public services more technology-driven across the state.



Sridhar Vembu Warns Students Against Overdependence on AI for Learning

As Artificial Intelligence tools become increasingly common in classrooms and workplaces, Sridhar Vembu has cautioned students against becoming overly dependent on AI chatbots for learning and problem-solving. Reacting to a viral discussion on X about AI-assisted education, Vembu argued that while AI tools may appear helpful in the short term, they could gradually weaken a student's ability to think independently and solve problems without assistance. His comments came in response to a post by Rimsha Bhardwaj referencing a 2025 research paper published in the Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS). The study examined how high school students performed while using AI tools to practice mathematics.

REAL-ESTATE



Inside Dharavi: Mumbai's Billion-Dollar Slum That Refuses to Bow Down

How do you write about Dharavi - a place that has been endlessly photographed, romanticised, politicised, dissected and, perhaps, misunderstood more than any other settlement in India? For decades, authors, filmmakers, politicians and urban planners have attempted to define Asia's largest slum. Yet Dharavi continues to resist simple narratives. It is neither merely a symbol of poverty nor just a story of survival. It is a city within a city, chaotic, wounded, overcrowded, yet astonishingly alive. Celebrated author Salman Rushdie once suggested that it takes months of immersion to truly understand Mumbai's slums. That complexity becomes immediately visible inside Dharavi's labyrinthine lanes, where entire lives begin, unfold and end without ever crossing the boundaries of the settlement. Among the many residents is Raju Hanumanta, a plumber born and raised in Dharavi who works exclusively within its dense network of homes and workshops. *"Gutter hai, par sone ka hai,"* he says with quiet pride. *"It's a gutter, but it's made of gold."*

Marco Rubio Arrives in India as US Seeks to Repair Strategic Ties

Many property buyers and sellers in India have traditionally preferred cash transactions. However, to improve financial transparency, the government has imposed strict limits under Section 269ST of the Income Tax Act. The key rule is clear: no individual or entity can receive ₹2 lakh or more in cash from a single person in one day. This restriction applies to all transactions, including real estate deals. Importantly, the responsibility lies with the receiver, not the payer. So, can you sell property in cash? The answer is yes, but only partially. While small portions of a deal can be in cash, any amount beyond ₹2 lakh must be paid through banking channels such as cheque, NEFT, RTGS, or other digital methods. Violating this rule can lead to severe consequences. If a seller accepts cash beyond the prescribed limit, they may face a penalty equal to 100 percent of the amount received, making it a highly risky move.



SUMIT BHRIYA
Founder & CEO
BRICKHILL GROUP

Message from Director's Desk

Global uncertainty may quietly become a big opportunity for Indian real estate.

Considering the ongoing geopolitical tensions, Indian real estate may see strong growth ahead. A weakening rupee increases NRI purchasing power, making Indian property more attractive globally. At the same time, financial markets remain volatile due to wars, oil shocks, and inflation, while real estate continues to offer tangible ownership, rental income, and long-term security. Rising costs of steel, cement, fuel, and transportation will make construction expensive, pushing new project prices higher and increasing the value of existing properties. With inflation reducing the purchasing power of cash, hard assets like land and property become stronger wealth-preservation tools. Tier-2 and tier-3 cities may offer the biggest opportunities ahead. Happy investing.

